# 食事の 介助

Meal Assistance — Scenario Dialogue

**Can-do: Announce mealtime, describe the food, encourage a resident to eat safely, and watch for choking.**

## 1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

**Hana (caregiver)**

**田中さん、お昼ごはんの 時間ですよ。**

Tanaka-san, it's lunchtime.

**Why:** お昼ごはん = 'lunch' — the お is a polite prefix that softens everyday nouns (you'll hear お茶, お水, お food words all day in care). ～ですよ gently informs the resident. Always announce with their name so they orient to what's happening.

**Tanaka-san (resident)**

**ああ、もう そんな 時間ですか。**

Oh, is it that time already?

**Why:** もう = 'already'; そんな時間 = 'that (kind of) time'. A natural, mild surprise. Notice residents often keep ～ですか (polite question) even when relaxed — don't worry about matching them exactly; you always stay polite.

**Hana (caregiver)**

**今日は お魚ですよ。**

Today it's fish.

**Why:** Telling the resident the menu (お魚 = fish, with polite お) helps their appetite and orients them to the moment — a small but caring habit. 今日は = 'as for today', marking the topic with は.

**Tanaka-san (resident)**

**おいしそうですね。**

It looks delicious.

**Why:** おいしそう = 'looks delicious'. Attach ～そう to an adjective stem (おいしい → おいし + そう) to say something *looks/seems* a certain way from appearance. The ね invites agreement.

**Hana (caregiver)**

**ゆっくり 召し上がってください。**

Please take your time and enjoy your meal.

**Why:** 召し上がる is the HONORIFIC (尊敬語) verb for 食べる/飲む ('to eat/drink'). Using an honorific for the RESIDENT's action raises them respectfully — exactly right in care. 召し上がってください = 'please eat'. ゆっくり ('slowly') keeps them safe and unhurried.

**Tanaka-san (resident)**

**いただきます。**

Thank you for the meal. (said before eating)

**Why:** いただきます is the fixed phrase said before eating — literally a humble 'I receive', expressing gratitude for the food. Everyone says it; encourage residents to as well. (After eating: ごちそうさまでした.)

**Hana (caregiver)**

**お茶(ちゃ)も どうぞ。むせないように 気(き)をつけてくださいね。**

Here's some tea too. Please be careful not to choke.

**Why:** どうぞ = 'here you are / please go ahead' when offering something. The key care phrase: むせる = 'to choke/cough on'; 〜ないように = 'so as NOT to 〜'; 気(き)をつけてください = 'please be careful'. Watching for choking (誤嚥(ごえん) aspiration) is one of a caregiver's most important safety duties.

**Tanaka-san (resident)**

**ありがとう。**

Thank you.

**Why:** Casual ありがとう from the resident. You would reply with the fuller ありがとうございます — the one-way politeness of care again.

**Hana (caregiver)**

**何(なに)か 手伝(てつだ)いましょうか。**

Shall I help you with anything?

**Why:** 何(なに)か = 'something / anything'. 手伝(てつだ)いましょうか uses 〜ましょうか = 'shall I 〜?' to OFFER to do something for them — polite and non-pushy. Offer help, but let them keep their independence (自立支援(じりつしえん)).

**Tanaka-san (resident)**

**大丈夫(だいじょうぶ)です。 自分(じぶん)で 食(た)べられます。**

I'm okay. I can eat by myself.

**Why:** 自分(じぶん)で = 'by myself'; 食(た)べられます is the potential form of 食(た)べる ('can eat'). A resident asserting independence — respect it warmly. Encouraging what they CAN still do themselves is central to good care.

## 2 · Key Vocabulary — 語彙

| # | 日本語 | ROMAJI | ENGLISH | メモ / NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | お昼(ひる)ごはん | *ohirugohan* | lunch | |
| 2 | 時間(じかん) | *jikan* | time | |
| 3 | もう | | already | |
| 4 | 今日(きょう) | *kyou* | today | |
| 5 | 魚(さかな) | *sakana* | fish | |
| 6 | おいしい | | delicious | |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | 召し上がる | *meshiagaru* | to eat/drink (honorific) | |
| 8 | ゆっくり | | slowly (recycled from Ep 1) | |
| 9 | いただきます | | (said before eating) | |
| 10 | お茶 | *ocha* | tea | |
| 11 | むせる | | to choke; to cough on food | |
| 12 | 気をつける | *kiotsukeru* | to be careful | |
| 13 | ありがとう | | thanks (casual) (recycled from Ep 1) | |
| 14 | 何か | *nanika* | something; anything | |
| 15 | 手伝う | *tetsudau* | to help (recycled from Ep 1) | |
| 16 | 自分 | *jibun* | oneself | |
| 17 | 食べられる | *taberareru* | can eat (potential) | |
| 18 | 大丈夫 | *daijoubu* | okay; fine (recycled from Ep 1) | |

## 3 · Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

| PATTERN | MEANING & USE |
|---|---|
| お + [everyday noun] | Polite/soft nouns — お昼[ひる]ごはん, お茶[ちゃ], お水[みず], お魚[さかな] |
| [adj-stem] + そう | 'looks / seems 〜' — おいしそう, たのしそう |
| 召し上がってください | Honorific 'please eat/drink' — for residents & guests |
| 〜ないように 気をつけてください | 'Please be careful not to 〜' — a core safety phrase |
| 何か 〜ましょうか | 'Shall I 〜 for you?' — offering help politely |

## 4 · Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

| # | SAY THIS IN JAPANESE | YOUR ANSWER |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | What is on today's menu? A) お肉 B) お魚 C) お茶だけ D) パン | |
| 2 | Hana offers help. What does Tanaka-san answer? A) お願いします B) 自分で食べられます C) もう いいです D) 手伝ってください | |
| 3 | Offer: 'Shall I help you with anything?' | |
| 4 | What is the honorific verb for 食べる (to eat)? | |
| 5 | Offer a drink too: 'Here's some tea as well.' | |

## 5 · Answer Key — こたえ

1. **今日は お魚ですよ。**
2. **大丈夫です。自分で 食べられます。**
3. **何か 手伝いましょうか。**
4. **召し上がる**
5. **お茶も どうぞ。**